

R1 Micro-Reflection Practice

Absorbs R7 (Reflection Time Management), R9 (Planning Reflection Slots), and R11 (Shorter, More Impactful Sessions). This is now the single worksheet for building reflection into the daily and weekly workflow.

Pillar	Reflection	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	30 minutes (setup), then 2-5 minutes daily	Group Size	Individual or team
Mode	Solo practice with optional team sharing	Format	Any
Prerequisites	None (foundation exercise)	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of time for reflection, reflection not embedded in workflow, low reflection engagement scores, reactive rather than deliberate working patterns

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Reflection activates the brain's default mode network (DMN), a system that operates during mental downtime and is responsible for insight, self-awareness, pattern recognition, and integrating new learning with existing knowledge. Without deliberate reflection, the DMN never gets the focused activation it needs, and learning remains shallow.

The critical insight is that reflection does not require long sessions. Research on spacing effects shows that brief, frequent reflection (2-5 minutes) produces better insight than infrequent long sessions (60 minutes quarterly). The brain consolidates learning through repetition, not duration. A 3-minute reflection every day for a month produces more behavioural change than a half-day workshop.

When people recognise their own growth through reflection, the brain releases serotonin (the chemical behind satisfaction and purpose). This self-recognition is intrinsically motivating in a way that external recognition cannot replicate.

IF A TEAM MEMBER ASKS "WHY ARE WE DOING THIS?"

"Most of us spend our days reacting to whatever comes next. We rarely pause to ask: what worked today? What didn't? What would I do differently? Those three questions, asked consistently, produce more professional growth than most training programmes. It takes 3 minutes. The return is disproportionate."

The Exercise

Phase 1: Choose Your Anchor Point (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Reflection fails when it's something extra you have to remember to do. It works when you attach it to something you already do every day. What's your anchor point? The last 3 minutes before you close your laptop? The commute home? The first coffee of the morning? Pick one moment that's already in your routine and attach reflection to it."

Each person identifies their anchor point and writes it down. The specificity matters: "end of the day" is too vague. "After I close my email and before I shut my laptop" is an anchor.

Phase 2: Select Your Reflection Format (10 minutes)

Not everyone reflects the same way. Offer options:

Format	How It Works
Three Questions	Write or think through: What worked? What didn't? What will I do differently? (2-3 minutes)
One Sentence	Complete this sentence: "The most important thing I learned/noticed/realised today was..." (1 minute)
Score and Note	Rate your day 1-10 and write one sentence about why. Over time, patterns emerge from the scores. (1 minute)
Voice Note	Record a 60-second voice memo to yourself. Particularly useful for people who process by talking rather than writing. (1 minute)
Photo Prompt	Take a photo of something from your day that represents a moment worth reflecting on. Write one sentence about it. (2 minutes)

FACILITATION NOTE

The format choice is personal and non-negotiable. If someone prefers voice notes and you insist on written journals, you'll get compliance for a week and abandonment by week three. Let people choose what fits their brain.

Phase 3: The 21-Day Commitment (5 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"I'm asking for 21 days. Not forever. Not even a month. 21 days of doing your chosen reflection at your chosen anchor point. After 21 days, we'll check in: is it producing anything useful? If yes, keep going. If not, we'll adjust the format or the prompts. But give it 21 days before deciding."

The 21-day frame reduces resistance. It feels finite and testable rather than permanent and obligatory.

Phase 4: Weekly Team Reflection (optional, 5 minutes in existing meeting)

If the team wants a shared reflection practice, add a 5-minute reflection round to an existing weekly meeting. Not a new meeting. A component of one that already exists.

WHAT TO SAY

"To close today, one thing each: what's something you noticed or learned this week that you want to carry into next week? One sentence. No pressure to be profound."

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
People stop after a few days	The anchor point was probably too vague or the format doesn't fit. Ask: "When specifically were you going to do it? What happened at that moment instead?" Help them find a more specific anchor or a simpler format. Switching from Three Questions to One Sentence can be enough to restart the habit.
Reflections become repetitive ("Same as yesterday")	Introduce rotation prompts: Monday (what worked), Tuesday (what frustrated me), Wednesday (what I learned from someone else), Thursday (what I'd do differently), Friday (what I'm proud of). Variety prevents autopilot.
Someone says reflection is "not how I work"	"That's fair. But consider: the people who say they don't need reflection are often the ones who would benefit most from it. You're currently processing everything in the moment without stepping back. Try it for 21 days and judge by results, not by how it feels at the start."

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
Within 1 week	People are doing the reflections (even if they feel mechanical) Someone reports noticing a pattern they hadn't seen before
Within 3 weeks	The reflection feels like a natural part of the routine, not an obligation Insights from reflection start appearing in work conversations ("I noticed this week that...") The weekly team reflection produces genuine observations, not performative ones
CLOVER ERA data (4-6 weeks)	Reflection pillar scores increase Learning scores may also improve (reflection reinforces learning retention) Qualitative data references noticing, awareness, or patterns
Red flags	If nobody is reflecting after 3 weeks, the anchor points or formats need adjusting. Do not blame motivation. Fix the system.

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
L3: Learning Journal	R1 and L3 can share the same daily habit slot. R1 is broader (any reflection); L3 is learning-specific.	Complementary (combine or alternate)
R2: From Ideas to Action	R1 produces insights. R2 converts them into behavioural change.	R1 feeds into R2
R3: Reflection Buddy System	R3 provides accountability for R1 practice. Buddies check in on whether the habit is alive.	R3 supports R1
V11: Workload Struggles	Daily reflection often surfaces workload patterns before they become crises.	R1 feeds into V11